

WHY DO WE NEED SOIL?

We often brush soil off newly bought mushrooms and vegetables. These are some of the foods that use the nutrients and water stored in soil to grow. Soil has lots of other important jobs, too, from holding up houses to cleaning water.



Without soil to absorb it, rain can cause floods.

Soil absorbs rain.

Filtering water

Soil is the largest water filter on Earth. As water flows downwards through the soil, small pores (openings) trap murky bits in the water. Soil also takes in some harmful substances that have made it into the water.

Animals release CO₂.

Getting rid of waste

Living things in soil eat organic waste and release it as nutrients into the soil, which help plants grow.